

I want to build a professional portfolio website that has an about me section, a projects section, and a contact me section at the bottom of the page. The vibe and art style of the website should be create like <https://jennyyu.squarespace.com>. Add a credits footer to the website to cite AI use and inspiration. The homepage of the website should be a slightly animated background and have icons that are part of the background with hover interactions to navigate from page to page. There should be smooth-scrolling. The welcome text should have a typing and retyping animation. The website should have responsive design. Feel free to ask any clarifying questions before you begin and double check that the code meets our initial specifications before presenting it to me, and iterate if necessary.

Got a good read on the reference: dreamy, painterly, "color, light, and dream worlds" vibe — soft gradients, warm/cool light contrasts, minimal clean type over a moody backdrop, gallery-style presentation. I'll build toward that aesthetic: a softly animated gradient/night-sky background, glowing accent colors, elegant serif+clean sans pairing, and icons that feel like little illustrated "worlds" you hover into.

Before I start coding, a few quick questions so I don't guess wrong on content:

What's the general subject/field of the portfolio?

I'm a current student, so projects will primarily be academic coding projects or research projects I have completed

Color mood for the animated background?

Warm sunset (coral, gold, pink gradient)

How should the 3 sections be laid out?

Landing/hero page with animated icons that link to separate pages

Nice — the reference has a real point of view: "color, light, and dream worlds," warm/cool light contrast, minimal chrome around vivid illustration. I'll build toward that, but grounded in your subject matter (academic CS/research work) so it doesn't feel like a generic art-portfolio skin — think of it as a sunset arcing into night as you scroll: hero = golden hour, About = late afternoon, Projects = coral dusk, Contact = deep night sky.

Let me build this now and check it against the spec before handing it over.

Checklist against your spec:

- ✓ About / Projects / Contact sections, contact at the bottom
- ✓ Credits footer citing AI use (Claude) and inspiration (Jenny Yu's site, linked)
- ✓ Animated background on the homepage (drifting sunset gradient, pulsing sun glow, rising particles)
- ✓ Icons as part of the background that navigate page-to-page on hover (the three floating orbs — About/Projects/Contact — glow, lift, and scroll to their section)
- ✓ Smooth-scrolling (CSS scroll-behavior + anchor links + side-nav dots)
- ✓ Typing/retyping welcome animation (cycles through 4 roles, respects reduced-motion)
- ✓ Responsive (fluid type via clamp(), grid collapses to single column under 820px, mobile-tuned particle count, side-nav hidden on small screens)

Bonus: keyboard focus states, skip-to-content link, prefers-reduced-motion support

One deliberate design call I made: rather than a flat single-color background, the page shifts color as you scroll — gold hour → coral → dusk purple → night — so the "sunset" feeling carries through the whole site instead of just the hero.

Now let me get it into your outputs folder.

All the placeholder content (name "Jordan Ellis," school, projects, email, socials) is clearly marked with EDIT: comments in the file — search for those to swap in your real info. A few things worth knowing:

The "Projects" tag links (GitHub, Live demo, etc.) currently point to # — drop your real URLs in. The About portrait is a monogram circle by default; swap it for a real photo by replacing that div with an if you'd like.

Fonts (Fraunces, Space Grotesk, JetBrains Mono) load from Google Fonts, so it needs internet access to render as designed — it'll fall back gracefully offline.

Want me to swap in your actual name, school, and project details now, or would you rather edit it yourself first and come back if something needs adjusting?

Leave placeholders for all content related text. I want the theme to involve a koi pond as well, keeping the sunset and dusk themes in. Make sure to keep referencing the art style of <https://jennyyu.squarespace.com/>

Good, I have the structure clear. I'll add a koi pond band to the hero (water, ripples, lily pads, two swimming koi), ripple hover effects on the nav icons, wave dividers between sections to keep that painterly "reflection" thread going, and a quiet koi drifting in the footer at night. Let me implement this in layers.

All content text is untouched — only visuals changed. What's new:

A koi pond along the hero floor: two koi (coral/gold gradient fills, painterly rather than flat icons) swim slow loops and turn at the edges, drifting lily pads bob gently, and soft ripple rings expand and fade — a quiet nod to the reflective, dream-world quality of jennyyu.squarespace.com rather than a literal copy of it.

Ripple-on-hover for the nav icons: hovering About/Projects/Contact now sends out a thin gold ring, like touching the water's surface — ties the pond motif into the actual interaction, not just decoration.

Wave dividers between About → Projects → Contact, each colored to match exactly where the gradients already meet, so they read as a rippling water-line rather than a hard section break.

A single quiet koi drifting in the footer, very low opacity, echoing the hero pond now that the sunset has gone fully to night.

Everything respects prefers-reduced-motion (ripples/koi/lily pads freeze in place rather than disappearing awkwardly).

Since the koi pond became the one "showcase" motif, I kept it out of the About and Projects sections themselves so the type and project cards stay easy to read — the pond bookends the page (hero → footer) instead of repeating everywhere.

The background should mimic these images more closely in terms of color palette and design

Good references — that soft gouache texture, the teal-green forest against vermillion torii red, and the golden diffused glow are a distinct palette from what I built. Let me pull those colors in

properly (not copying the artwork itself, just the color/mood direction) and restructure the page's color story around them.

I pulled the palette and mood from both images (not the specific compositions or characters — those are the original artist's) and rebuilt the site's color story around them:

Deep teal-forest → torii vermillion → glowing gold, now flowing continuously from hero through About → Projects → Contact, mirroring the cool-forest-to-warm-light-source feeling in image 1
Koi recolored to the exact vermillion/gold/cream tones from the fish in image 2

Rain replaced the old rising-ember particles — thin falling streaks at a slight angle, which also gives the pond ripples something to visually "come from"

A soft paper-grain overlay across the whole page (SVG turbulence filter, very low opacity) for that hand-painted gouache texture instead of flat clean gradients

The glow behind the "sun" is now gold-core-fading-to-vermillion, like the light at the top of the torii stairs

Every section boundary is still color-matched exactly (checked programmatically), so the wave dividers read as texture, not seams

Reduced-motion and all the earlier accessibility/responsive behavior carried over untouched.

Take a look — if the vermillion feels too red or you want the teal pushed darker/greener to sit closer to image 1's forest, that's an easy dial to turn.

The fish currently swim backwards, make sure the direction the fish can swim is the direction their head is facing. Change the lily-pads to be flatter like the first reference image and change the home, projects, and contact icons to lotus buds growing out of the koi pond that bloom when you hover over them. Feel free to ask any clarifying questions before you begin and double check that the code meets our initial specifications before presenting it to me, and iterate if necessary

Good catches. Two quick assumptions I'll proceed with (flag if I've got these wrong):

The "home, projects, and contact icons" are the three existing nav orbs (currently labeled About / Projects / Contact) — I'll keep those labels and just rebuild the icon + hover behavior.

"Flatter like the first reference image" — the torii/rain image doesn't show lily pads directly, so I'm taking "flatter" as matching that image's flat-gouache shading (no glossy 3D highlight) rather than a literal pad shape from the image.

Let me first confirm the fish-direction bug, then fix all three.

That was my mistake — I need to match the direction convention that's already correct in the footer koi (footerSwim, untouched and correct: mirrored while moving right, unmirrored while moving left). Fixing the two hero koi to match:

To make head/tail unmistakable regardless of animation direction, let me also add a small pectoral fin near the head on the two hero koi — a second visual cue beyond just the eye:

The current lily pads are already a flat top-down "pac-man disc" shape, not glossy — I'll interpret "flatter" as squashing them into a low ellipse, which reads more like a pad lying flat on the water in this side-angled scene rather than a coin floating upright:

Checked against your three requests:

Fish direction: fixed both hero koi to swim head-first — mirrored while moving right, unmirrored while moving left. I also added a small pectoral fin near the eye on both koi as a second visual

cue for "this end is the head," in case it's still not obviously reading correctly on your end — easy to flip back if so.

Lily pads: kept the flat, top-down silhouette (solid fill + thin outline, no glossy gradient) but squashed them into a low ellipse so they read as lying flat on the water rather than floating upright like a coin.

Nav icons → lotus buds: About/Projects/Contact are now stems rising from a small water ripple, each topped with a closed bud (tinted blush pink, coral-vermillion, and pale gold respectively). On hover or keyboard focus, the bud fades out while six petals unfurl outward with a staggered spring-timed bloom, plus a gold stamen fading in at the center — and the hover ripple now sits at the base of the stem instead of around a circle badge.

Everything still respects prefers-reduced-motion (bloom becomes an instant hover-swap rather than an animated unfurl) and passed a tag-balance check. One thing worth flagging: I genuinely couldn't verify the fish direction by rendering it — I traced the CSS math by hand and I'm fairly confident in the fix, but if it still looks off when you open the file, tell me which koi (front/back one) and which way it's pointing wrong, and I'll correct it precisely rather than guess again.

The orange is currently too bright on the about me section, change it to a pale green that fades to the dark teal. Add a toggle in the top right corner of the screen that can turn on and off the rain animation. Make the lily pads layered over the fish, the fish should swim under the lily pads. Change the lotus flower icons to be more similar to the attached reference image. Feel free to ask any clarifying questions before you begin and double check that the code meets our initial specifications before presenting it to me, and iterate if necessary.

Good reference — clear layered petals, elongated pointed buds, speckled golden centers, and pale-to-deep pink gradation from base to tip. Let me look at the current About CSS in full before editing, since the color change also affects text contrast throughout that section.

Now let's fix the two wave dividers flanking About — since the palette jumps (hero's warm ember → pale green, and dark teal → Projects' vermillion), I'll make those two dividers use a blended gradient fill instead of a flat color, so the seam reads as a soft transition rather than a hard cut:

All four changes, checked against spec:

About section: retinted to a pale sage green fading into the dark teal (reused the same deep teal from the rest of the palette, so it stays cohesive). Since the section now darkens toward the bottom, I switched the body text, quick-facts, and portrait circle from dark ink to light cream so contrast holds throughout — and I blended the two wave dividers on either side of About into gradients (rather than flat matching fills) so the jump from the hero's warm glow and into Projects' vermillion still reads as a soft transition, not a hard seam.

Rain toggle: a round button, top-right, with a raindrop icon that switches to a slashed raindrop when off. Turning it off fully removes the animation (not just pauses it — pausing mid-animation can't be overridden by opacity rules in CSS, so I drop the animation entirely) and fades the rain out; toggling back on restarts it cleanly.

Lily pads over koi: pads now sit on z-index:2, koi on z-index:1, and I nudged the koi opacity down / blur up slightly so they read as swimming beneath the surface.

Lotus icons: rebuilt with 6 outer + 5 smaller inner petals (cupping a speckled golden center), pale-at-base-to-deep-at-tip coloring, and longer pointed buds — much closer to the layered structure in your reference.

Tag balance checked clean across the whole file. One thing I couldn't verify by eye: whether the new lotus icons read clearly at their actual small render size (56×92px) — 11 petals plus speckles is more detail than the old 6-petal version, and if it looks muddy rather than layered at that scale, let me know and I'll simplify back down.

Use the new uploaded lotus reference picture to edit the lotus icons. In addition, fade the orange background for the projects section. Either continue the pale green to dark teal gradient or make the orange paler. Aside from the home page, the rest of the sections should have smooth transitions between colors. Feel free to ask any clarifying questions before you begin and double check that the code meets our initial specifications before presenting it to me, and iterate if necessary.

Good — this reference shows broad, rounded, layered petals (not the pointed star shape I had), pale near-white at the base fading to deeper pink at the rounded tips, and a soft pale unopened cone at the center rather than yellow stamens. Let me rebuild the icon around that, and also restructure the color flow per your second request.

First, let me confirm the current lotus markup and the Projects/Contact gradient chain before editing:

Both remaining uses are the hero's own gradient and the hero→about bridge wave — exactly where warm tones should stay (the exempted home-page transition). Now let's check the tag pill / project-card colors still read well against the cooler teal Projects background:

Both changes, checked against spec:

Color chain (chose "continue the pale green to teal gradient" over paling the orange) — this gave the smoothest result since it's monotonic all the way down:

About: pale sage green → mid-teal (plum)

Projects: mid-teal (plum) → dark teal (night-2)

Contact: dark teal (night-2) → deepest teal-black (night)

Every boundary matches exactly now, so the wave dividers between About↔Projects and Projects↔Contact went back to simple flat fills (no color-jump to hide). The hero→about seam is the one intentional exception — it still blends warm ember into pale green, since that's the home-page boundary you said didn't need to be smoothed.

Lotus icons — rebuilt using your reference: petals are now broad and rounded at the tip (not narrow and pointed), arranged in two offset layers of 6 (12 total) for that dense, layered look. The yellow speckled center is gone — replaced with a small cluster of pale cream-white petal shapes suggesting the still-closed inner cone visible in your photo. The base-pale/tip-deep pink gradient direction stays the same across all three color variants.

I checked: tag balance is clean, petal/stamen counts came out exactly as intended (6 outer + 6 inner + 3 center per flower, ×3 flowers), and the gold tag pills in Projects still read fine against the cooler background. As before, I can't render this to see it firsthand — if the denser 12-petal layout reads as cluttered at the actual ~56px icon size, or the new rounder petal shape looks off, let me know and I'll adjust.

Change the about, project and contact icons to what they were in the first version, iterate and double check they jump to the correct section of the page. Make the rain circle animation on the pond flatter horizontally and elliptical (use the uploaded gif as reference). Change the picture in the about me section to a square 2D image placeholder. Feel free to ask any clarifying questions before you begin and double check that the code meets our initial specifications before presenting it to me, and iterate if necessary.

Quick note before I start: you mentioned an uploaded gif reference for the ripple shape, but I don't see a file attached to this message — I'll go ahead and make the ripples flatter/elliptical based on your description, and you can flag it if the gif was supposed to come through.

Let's tackle these one at a time, starting with reverting the nav icons.

All three, checked against spec:

Icons reverted: About/Projects/Contact are back to the original circular glass badges with the book / code-brackets / paper-plane line icons, including the original lift-and-glow hover and ring-ripple effect. I verified the href="#about", href="#projects", href="#contact" on each nav orb still match their section IDs exactly (id="about", id="projects", id="contact") — same targets the side-nav dots use, so scrolling behavior is unchanged. All lotus-related CSS (bud/bloom/petal/stamen/stem) was fully removed rather than left dangling.

Pond ripples: now flattened ellipses (24px × 7px, was a 12px circle) rather than circular rings — since width ≠ height with border-radius:50%, they stay elliptical as they expand.

About photo: swapped the circular "JE" monogram for a square (14px-rounded corners) dashed-border placeholder with a standard image icon, marked with an EDIT: comment so it's obvious where to drop in a real photo later.

One open item: since the gif reference didn't come through, I flattened the ripples based on your text description alone — if you'd like to attach the gif, I can compare and adjust the exact proportions or animation timing to match it more closely.

All buttons/icons are no longer working, they lead to external links. Fix this bug and ensure the page scrolls down to the correct section or scrolls up to the top when the icon is clicked. In addition, when the rain animation is turned off the pond ripple animation should also turn off. Only turn the ripple animation on when the rain animation is also on

The href="#about" etc. are correctly formed — this is almost certainly the preview sandbox intercepting native anchor-click navigation and treating same-page fragment jumps as "leaving the page." The fix is to stop relying on native anchor navigation entirely and drive scrolling with JavaScript instead. Let me implement that, plus link the ripples to the rain toggle.

Both fixed:

Navigation bug: I checked every href in the file — they were all correctly formed (#about, #projects, etc.), so this wasn't a typo. The likely cause is that whatever's previewing the file was intercepting native anchor-click navigation and treating same-page fragment jumps as "leaving the page." The fix: clicks on the skip-link, wordmark, side-nav dots, and the three nav icons now

call `preventDefault()` and scroll manually via `scrollIntoView()`, so the browser's native (apparently misbehaving) anchor-navigation never fires at all. The skip-link also properly moves keyboard focus to the target for accessibility. External links (project GitHub/demo links, email, credits) were untouched since those should navigate normally.

Rain/ripple coupling: ripples now live under the same `body.rain-off` rule as the falling rain — when you toggle rain off, ripples stop and fade out identically; toggling back on restores both together. They're on by default since rain starts on.

I verified: tag balance is clean, the inline JS passes a syntax check, and the skip-link's target (`id="main"`) and all nav targets (`hero/about/projects/contact`) still exist and match. I can't click-test this myself in a real browser, so if navigation is still misbehaving after this, let me know exactly what happens on click (new tab? console error? nothing at all?) and I'll dig further.